

MODDABLE CHESS · VARIANT 117 OF 153

Recruitment Chess

8×8

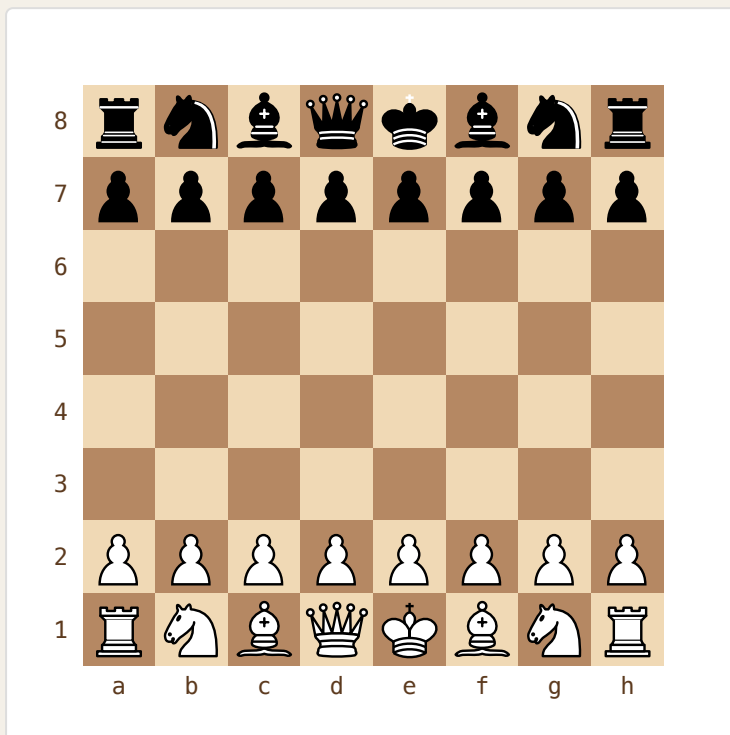
BOARD

2

PLAYERS

RECRUITMENT CHESS

Captured pieces switch sides. When you capture, the taken piece flips colour and appears on the square your capturing piece vacated. The board fills with turncoats.



Recruitment Chess – starting position

SETUP

Board: Standard 8×8.

Setup: Standard chess setup.

FEN: rnbqkbnr/pppppppp/8/8/8/8/PPPPPPPP/RNBQKBNR w KQkq - 0 1

RULES

- When a piece captures, the captured piece switches colour and is placed on the square the capturing piece moved from.
- Kings cannot be recruited (capturing the King ends the game normally).
- En passant captures also recruit – the captured pawn appears on the captor's starting square.
- Recruited pieces can move on the very next turn.
- All other standard chess rules apply.

WIN CONDITION

Checkmate the opponent's King.

STRATEGY

Every capture is a double swing — you gain a piece AND the opponent gains a defector behind your lines. This makes tactical exchanges far more complex. Avoid capturing pieces that would create dangerous recruits in your back rank. Sometimes not capturing is the best move.

ATTRIBUTION

Modern variant. Public domain.